WEEKLY TRENDS
FOR SPC GLOBAL
ISSUE 2

WHAT ARE WE SEEING AROUND THE WORLD THIS WEEK?

Protein is getting expensive.

Alli & Kahn
Eclectic innovation team

Whey prices are at record highs while clear protein drinks keep multiplying, with Bloom now at Target and Myprotein in UK protein water. At home, the regulator is moving Health Star Ratings toward mandatory, and Liquid Death has landed in Woolworths. Coca-Cola also showed its 2027 slate: prebiotic soda, a zero-sugar sports drink and a new Core Power flavour.

Week of 19–25 October 2026

131 SIGNALS TRACKED

7 MARKETS

22 PACK & DESIGN IDEAS

Act on this now

PROTEIN COSTS GLOBAL

Whey shortage pushes protein drink makers toward plant-dairy hybrids

US whey concentrate is still about 134% above year-ago prices and Europe is up about 122%. ADM, Puris, Roquette and NNB/Axiom have all launched new soy and pea proteins for hybrid dairy-plant RTDs this year.

Why it matters: Any whey-based drink in the SPC range, Stacked included, faces a cost squeeze. Lock in supply now and get a hybrid protein recipe on the bench as a fallback.

FoodNavigator · Read the story

REGULATION AUSTRALIA

FSANZ moves toward a mandatory Health Star Rating

The regulator is consulting on a start date for making Health Star Ratings mandatory. They are voluntary today.

Why it matters: If it goes mandatory, every SPC pack will need a star rating. Score the drinks range now so any reformulation is planned, not rushed.

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CHALLENGER AUSTRALIA

Liquid Death launches in Australia and lands in Woolworths

The US cult canned water and soda brand came in through distributor Soulfresh and secured Woolworths listings.

Why it matters: A brand built on attitude, not ingredients, is now fighting for the same drinks fridge space as SPC's beverage brands.

Food & Drink Business · Read the story

Beverages & coconut water

INNOVATION FOODBEV

Coca-Cola unveils its 2027 drinks slate at NACS

Prebiotic Coke, Sprite and Fresca with 6g fibre, BodyArmor Fit zero-sugar sparkling sports drink, Vitaminwater Formula 100, and Fairlife Core Power Banana, its first new flavour in a decade.

Why it matters: The biggest drinks company is betting on gut health, hydration and protein at once. Those are the same spaces SPC's beverage brands play in.

FoodBev · Read the story

PROTEIN WATER FOODBEV

Bloom Nutrition takes a clear protein drink into Target

The influencer-founded wellness brand is bringing a clear, non-milky protein drink to Target shelves.

Why it matters: Clear protein is spreading from sports brands to lifestyle brands. It is a format worth testing for Stacked.

FoodBev · Read the story

FUNCTIONAL STOCKWIREX

Flavoured kava FZZR lands in 583 Coles stores

Calmer Co's FZZR Piña Colada kava 10-pack is the first flavoured kava in Australian supermarkets. Its existing range sales rose 33% at Woolworths and 27% at Coles quarter on quarter.

Why it matters: Coles is giving space to new functional 'calm' drinks. That is a cue for The Daily Ritual's next wellness launch.

StockWireX · Read the story

RTD TEA FOODNAVIGATOR

Coca-Cola, PepsiCo and Spindrift reposition RTD tea as growth stalls

Four ways the majors are trying to revive flat RTD tea: premium tiers, functional add-ins, smaller and cleaner formats, and new flavours.

Why it matters: A playbook for reviving any flat drinks line, without starting a new brand.

FoodNavigator · Read the story

Protein, dairy & yoghurt

PROTEIN COFFEE FOODNAVIGATOR

'Profee' goes mainstream with Starbucks and Oikos protein coffees

Starbucks and PepsiCo's bottled Coffee & Protein has 22g protein and 2g sugar. Danone's Oikos Mocha Latte shake has 30g protein and about 95mg caffeine.

Why it matters: Protein and coffee in one bottle is now a big-brand play, not a TikTok hack.

FoodNavigator · Read the story

DAIRY COSTS EU MILK MARKET OBSERVATORY / INDEXBOX

EU butter up 55% while skim milk powder falls 31%

To 18 October: butter €401/100kg (+55% YoY), skim milk powder €337 (-31%), whey powder €156 (+5%), and most cheeses down 14% to 27%.

Why it matters: Fat is dear and powder is cheap. Recipes that lean on milk solids rather than cream get a cost edge.

EU Milk Market Observatory / IndexBox · Read the story

AUSTRALIA FOOD & DRINK BUSINESS

Apta Group buys a majority stake in Alba Cheese

The PE-backed dairy group, which also owns Village Dairy Australia and Southern Valley, beat multinational bidders for the Victorian cheesemaker.

Why it matters: Apta keeps adding scale in Australian dairy, which means a stronger rival in every dairy range review.

Food & Drink Business · Read the story

Retail & rules

AUSTRALIA DAIRY NEWS TODAY

Woolworths to phase out Farmers' Own milk by mid-2027

A shift in Woolworths' home-brand milk strategy. The exact announcement date is unconfirmed.

Why it matters: A range change in the milk fridge opens a conversation with the buyer about what fills the space.

Dairy News Today · Read the story

EREWHON EXPRESS TRIBUNE

Erewhon's Zara Larsson smoothie is built on coconut water

A US$21 20oz smoothie on MALK coconut milk and coconut water with A2 whey, collagen, colostrum and mushrooms, sold until 7 November. Several ingredient brands are publicising the same drink.

Why it matters: Being the named base in a viral café drink is free brand-building. Casa Coco could chase the same role with an Australian café or venue.

Express Tribune · Read the story

Pay homage to: pack & design

COCONUT WATER THE DIELINE

Above Water's coconut water cans go folk art

Folk-inspired illustration and irregular type on a warm cream base give each flavour its own 'strange little world'.

How we'd use it: Pay homage to it on a Casa Coco limited edition: one illustrated world per flavour makes coconut water feel collectible.

The Dieline · Read the story

PROVENANCE THE DIELINE

Poland Spring's sparkling refresh nods to vintage national park posters

Rolling hills, pine forests and a winding blue spring line replace oversized fruit, with the sky colour changing per flavour.

How we'd use it: Pay homage to it by telling where a drink comes from with landscape, not fruit. It suits any Australian-grown story.

The Dieline · Read the story

LIMITED EDITION THE DIELINE

Trevi Hydration goes full horror movie for Halloween

A coffin-shaped box, Gothic lettering and a glowing crimson droplet for a Tiger's Blood x Blood Orange mashup.

How we'd use it: Pay homage to it with a seasonal drop that breaks your own category codes for one moment, then goes back to normal.

The Dieline · Read the story

Opportunity of the week

8
/10

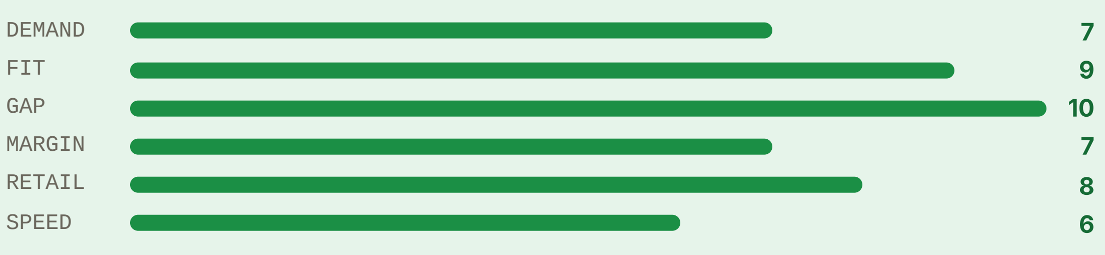
Go Bananas: Aussie banana water

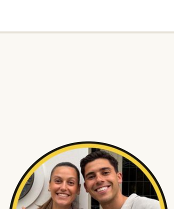
$3.50 single · $12 4-pack

Single-ingredient banana water with natural potassium and magnesium. Original plus Mango and Passionfruit, sitting right next to coconut water for the shopper who is bored with it or doesn't like the taste.

Banagua reached just over 3,000 US doors in four months and Banam has launched in Europe, but there is no banana water in Australian grocery. It is coconut water's first real cousin, and SPC already knows this shelf and this shopper.

Pack idea: Own yellow on the shelf: a slim can with 'BANANA WATER' huge on pack and a 'saved from the paddock' banana count per can.





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Do the homework, then commit and go hard.

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